The current issue and full text archive of this journal is available at
www.emeraldinsight.com/0265-1335.htm

GUEST EDITORIAL

International market selection and segmentation: perspectives and challenges

Nicolas Papadopoulos
Sprott School of Business, Carleton University, Ottawa, Canada, and
Oscar Martín Martín
Department of Business Administration, Public University of Navarre, Pamplona, Spain and Department of Business Studies, Uppsala University, Uppsala, Sweden

Abstract

Purpose – This paper has two overall goals. The first is to serve as a broad overview of the literature on the subject theme, with three main objectives in mind: to highlight the complexities of international market selection or segmentation as a field of study and as a strategic decision by international firms; to explore the various ways and perspectives from which this area has been studied; and to suggest areas for future research by drawing on the preceding discussion. The second goal of the paper is to act as an introduction to the *IMR* special issue on the title theme, by outlining the special issue's objectives and the contributions to it.

Design/methodology/approach – Drawing on the relevant literatures, the paper begins by outlining the factors that make the field complex in both theoretical and applied terms, moves to consider the research streams that comprise its main components, and concludes by drawing conclusions and implications for future research.

Findings – A large part of the complexity characterizing this field arises from the fact that it is closely intertwined with the broader area of internationalization and a number of other decisions related to it, such as the "go/no-go" decision and the firm's choice of mode of entry. From the research perspective, theory development has been impeded by a high degree of fragmentation, which has resulted in various different streams studying the same general issues from widely different perspectives.

Research limitations/implications – The paper identifies a large number of directions for potential future research, not the least of which is the need for integrative research that addresses the fragmentation identified in the study.

Practical implications – Although this is primarily a theoretical paper directed at researchers, practitioners can gain useful insights from it by examining the various factors that have a bearing on their internationalization decisions.

Originality/value – The objectives of the main part of the paper will have been met if it succeeds in stimulating interest in further research and discussion on the core issues. The second part summarizes the contributions to the special issue and draws attention to the main message that each aims to convey.

Keywords International business, Marketing opportunities, Market segmentation, Risk assessment
Paper type Viewpoint

Introduction

International business is conducted in an increasingly globalized environment characterized by fewer barriers, growing competition, and greater opportunities for expansion. Still, notwithstanding the general trend to globalization, the particular environments in which a firm operates are the result of the various strategic decisions it takes throughout its internationalization process. One such strategic decision is the

International Marketing Review
Vol. 28 No. 2, 2011
pp. 132-149
© Emerald Group Publishing Limited
0265-1335
DOI 10.1108/02651331111122632

Downloaded from www.emerald.com/imr/article-pdf/28/2/132/1280656/02651331111122632.pdf by Vilnius University user on 30 October 2026

selection (Root, 1994; Sakarya *et al.*, 2007) or segmentation (Day *et al.*, 1988; Steenkamp and ter Hofstede, 2002) of international markets – namely, the decision by which firms choose the markets, whether defined geographically or otherwise, in which to be present.

We posit that at base both "selection" and "segmentation" decisions are, by definition, segmentation decisions in the traditional marketing sense. The difference between the two terms is conditioned, simply, by how "market" is defined. Typically, the term "selection" is used when the decision focuses on segmenting the world based on national country markets, while "segmentation" is used when the firm attempts to identify markets cross-nationally by drawing on characteristics that various types of buyers share regardless of where they live. Largely because of this distinction in the segmentation base used, these two fields have evolved over time as distinct streams in research. To confuse matters, both fields share the same acronym – and while both essentially deal with "segmentation", the "selection" stream was chronologically the first to evolve, thus laying claim to the acronym "IMS" – a most typical case of semantics-driven academic confusion if there ever was one!

For the purposes of this paper, we propose a distinction that we have also put forth recently elsewhere (Papadopoulos *et al.*, 2011) between IMSel, for "selection", and IMSeg, for "segmentation". This leaves "IMS" as the generic term to apply to both decision types, with the meaning of the "S" being up to the reader's discretion. At the end of the day, whether one "selects" a market from among a set of countries or of cross-national segments, or "segments" the global market by country or by cross-national buyer groups, is a semantic issue. The decision task is the same in both cases, and what differs is the criterion chosen for selection/segmentation along with the strategic and tactical implications of that choice.

Against this background, this paper has two main goals. First, to highlight the complexities of IMS as a field of study and as a strategic decision, to explore the various ways and perspectives from which this area has been studied, and to identify new avenues for research in the title field. And second, to introduce the *IMR* special issue by outlining its objectives and the contributions to it.

IMS in research and practice: key characteristics and challenges

IMS has several key characteristics which present interesting opportunities for research at the same time as they constitute challenges for both researchers and decision makers. This section outlines some of the most noteworthy and consequential of these characteristics.

IMS is complex

IMS is a complex topic for a number of reasons related to the intrinsic features of the process, the a priori information and knowledge required if IMS decisions are to be made systematically and effectively, the level of analysis used, the characteristics of the decision maker, and other factors. More specifically:

- We conceive IMS as a boundedly rational decision (Simon, 1959) governed by the firm – that is, the rationality of decision makers is constrained by their cognitive limitations, their limited amount of time for decision making, the market information they have, and the imperfections of available decision-making models. IMS needs to be considered not only as a strategic decision but also as a problem of choice in which the objective is to select target markets, whether for

Downloaded from www.emerald.com/imr/article-pdf/28/2/132/1280656/02651331111122632.pdf by Vilnius University user on 30 October 2026

initial or further expansion, from the available full set of national or cross-national foreign markets. This boundedly rational decision-making perspective of IMS, together with the large number and diversity of foreign markets and the transaction cost economics involved, provide theoretical foundation to make the selection process sequentially and as efficient and effective as possible. This aspect has been reflected in the literature suggesting an initial screening stage (e.g. Cavusgil *et al.*, 2004) in which low-cost, widely available secondary sources of comparative information about countries (typically macro factors) would offer the necessary information for discarding large numbers of unsuitable countries from further analysis. At the same time, as is also stressed in the Douglas and Craig paper that is part of this special issue, a stepwise, sequential-choice process carries the inherent risk of excluding early on from the consideration set markets that should have been retained, or vice versa, for reasons that might become apparent only at later stages in the process, if ever. This conundrum constitutes one of the most important factors that make IMS decisions complex and difficult.

- IMS involves the search of comparative information about countries, industries, products and/or consumers, and the use of market and market selection knowledge. The availability of comparative information is scarce at some levels of analysis, making IMS decisions more difficult. In addition, part of the knowledge required to increase the reliability of the decision is difficult to collect prior to market entry – for instance, selection of a national or cross-national target market based on psychographic consumer characteristics would require research in multiple markets that is likely to be too expensive for the vast majority of firms. Furthermore, some of the competencies that decision makers need to possess in order to increase the effectiveness of the decision are, to some extent, accumulated though experience and refined by practice. The inherent complexity of the knowledge required and of the process means that few decision makers have enough knowledge to carry out a systematic market selection process.
- The features of the decision maker affect several aspects of the process, including the objectives of the selection decision and the relevance and suitability of the selection criteria. Differences are expected, for example, between non-internationalized and internationalized firms, small- and medium-sized vs multinational enterprises (SMEs and MNEs), public/institutional vs private sector decision makers, and across industries. The objectives and importance of the selection criteria will also vary within each of these groups – for instance, between market- vs resource-seeking MNEs.

IMS is inherently difficult in practice

Because, in the end, IMS is more a decision to be made by practitioners than an issue to be debated among researchers, it is important to elaborate on the practical side of the complexities discussed above. International segmentation can be particularly challenging for practitioners for several reasons, including:

- IMS necessitates understanding cultures that are, by definition, "foreign" to the marketer.
- While at home the segmentation task concerns a given population, internationally the firm must first select a population(s) to segment. With over

Downloaded from www.emerald.com/imr/article-pdf/28/2/132/1280656/02651331111122632.pdf by Vilnius University user on 30 October 2026

200 nations and territories internationally (IMSel), not to mention hundreds of different types of segments across these markets if a cross-national approach is preferred (IMSeg), the task is one of great magnitude indeed.

- While in earlier decades the number of viable and accessible markets for most firms was relatively small, today this has ballooned to levels that are hard to conceptualize and handle for most firms as a result of various factors including the fall of communism, the advent of emerging and transitional economies, and the spectacular growth of such huge markets as India and China.
- Developed countries produce a vast array of information about their home markets, which can be used in both IMSel and IMSeg (e.g. targeting decisions within the European Union). However, in the vast majority of international markets, which comprises emerging and developing countries, advanced information is almost totally unavailable and even basic data, such as education or income levels, are unavailable, dated, or suspect – which makes IMSel difficult and IMSeg virtually impossible.
- Extant research is consistent in suggesting that few managers use systematic approaches for IMS (e.g. Westhead *et al.*, 2001; Papadopoulos and Martín Martín, 2010), and the preponderance of smaller entrepreneurial firms in the current trend to internationalization is likely to further exacerbate this since entrepreneurs typically engage more in intuitive than systematic decision making (e.g. Sarasvathy, 2001). However, the research evidence is that perceived assessments of international market attractiveness most often differ greatly from objective assessments, and that, even when managers' overall assessment approximates actual conditions, it fails to account for temporal shifts that change the attractiveness of regions relative to each other (Martín Martín and Papadopoulos, 2005).

IMS is important

Notwithstanding the above difficulties, the literature consistently stresses that IMS is an important decision (Papadopoulos and Denis, 1988; Douglas and Craig, 1992; Whitelock and Jobber, 2004; Malhotra *et al.*, 2009). Its importance is due to a number of reasons, and we argue that these apply to both the IMSel and IMSeg components of IMS.

- Foreign markets are still highly diverse, and the features, attractiveness, risks, potential profits, and so on that are associated with doing business in them vary tremendously. In this context it is necessary to note that, despite the ongoing globalization process, prevailing market conditions are, to a great extent, country- and/or culture- specific (e.g. de Mooij, 2004). This argues for the continuing importance of IMSel, notwithstanding, as will be seen below, the theoretical argument that favours IMSeg – namely, that there is no inherent reason why "country" should always be used as the selection/segmentation criterion of choice in international expansion decisions.
- Within this context, firms can follow an internationalization process in which they, strategically or opportunistically and proactively or reactively, select and enter foreign markets (Johanson and Vahlne, 1977; Martín Martín and Papadopoulos, 2005). Systematic IMS is a major determining factor of international performance (Brouthers *et al.*, 2009) especially in the early stages of the internationalization process (Martín Martín and Papadopoulos, 2007). In

Downloaded from www.emerald.com/imr/article-pdf/28/2/132/1280656/02651331111122632.pdf by Vilnius University user on 30 October 2026

addition, there are costs of venturing into the wrong markets and opportunity costs associated with failing to enter the right markets.

- IMS is related to the firm's competitive positioning and its global value chain in the physical/geographical sense. Gaining a foothold in the right foreign markets can be a key factor in firms' global competitive strategy. The nature and geographical location of the selected markets will condition firms' ability to coordinate the ensuing international operations.
- The choice of target markets comes before the development of local strategies and international marketing programmes, and therefore it has a major influence on the form that these will take.

IMS is part of a broad decision-making set

Generally, IMS is thought of as a process that begins after the decision to initiate or extend internationalization and ends when it is decided whether or not to act upon the results of the selection process (e.g. Papadopoulos and Denis, 1988). As such, both the complexities and the importance of IMS are exacerbated, since market selection and targeting decisions are closely interrelated with a number of other decisions that are part and parcel of the expansion process. This includes, notably, internationalization, i.e., the international expansion of firms. Interestingly, research is very scant on the relationship between IMSel and IMSeg, on the one hand, and various internationalization theories, on the other, including the incremental model (Johanson and Vahlne, 1977), the eclectic paradigm (Dunning, 1988), the network approach (Johanson and Mattsson, 1988), the contingency or business strategy approach (Robertson and Chetty, 2000), and research that addresses the "Born Global" phenomenon (Oviatt and McDougall, 1994).

A second closely related decision concerns the choice of mode of entry (MOE). IMS and MOE are closely interrelated: a decision "to export" (MOE) precludes consideration of markets (IMS) where investment might be necessary, just like a decision "to go to market X" (IMS) may narrow the choice of entry methods (MOE) if, for instance, the chosen target country restricts foreign investment or franchise operations. Since each decision alone is central to successful internationalization, the relationship between them makes the two combined even more important. Needless to say, these decisions are also important downstream – as mentioned above, they affect all subsequent strategic decisions, such as, for example, the extent to which the firm might need or want to adapt or standardize its strategies across markets or the design of specific elements of the marketing mix. Yet, notwithstanding their importance, research on the IMS-MOE relationship is scant (for a notable exception see Koch, 2001).

IMS research and practice are fragmented

IMSel and IMSeg may be the main areas comprising the broader field of "IMS", but still are only two of several subfields that are part of the overall construct. Others include country risk analysis, international opportunity analysis, environmental scanning, and foreign investment location choice. Regrettably, this multiplicity of related fields has led to fragmentation in both research and practice. In research, as will be seen in the next main section, each stream has developed in almost complete independence of the other. In business, a long stream of researchers from Douglas *et al.* (1982) onwards have indicated that firms also collect and use information in fragmented ways – for instance, the same or similar country-based indicators may be collected and used by a

Downloaded from www.emerald.com/imr/article-pdf/28/2/132/1280656/02651331111122632.pdf by Vilnius University user on 30 October 2026

firm's forecasting department for "environmental scanning", by its foreign investment unit for "country risk assessment", by its marketing division for "IMS", and so on, each unit acting independent of the others and rarely sharing information with them.

IMS is under-researched

Many noted scholars, including Tamer Cavusgil, Susan Douglas, Stanley Reid, Franklin Root, and Jan-Benedict Steenkamp, have stressed in their writings that IMS decisions are a critical success factor in international market expansion. As a result, the area has attracted considerable research attention – but, at the same time, this research is characterized by two main problems: a high level of fragmentation, as described above, coupled with a relative lack of empirical studies on both the IMSeg and IMSel sides (Steenkamp and ter Hofstede, 2002; Leonidou *et al.*, 2002). For instance, a systematic review of the broader literature, including all the major substreams, identified fewer than 40 empirical IMS studies, with about one-half of these in fact drawing on secondary data (Malhotra and Papadopoulos, 2007; also see Douglas and Craig, 1992). The combination of these two factors impedes both the cross-fertilization of ideas (fragmentation) and the development of theory (lack of primary research).

Main streams of research in IMS

This section outlines extant research in the main streams identified above, beginning with some subfields that have attracted relatively less attention in the IMS context and then moving on to the two main components of IMSel and IMSeg.

International opportunity analysis

In the early years of international marketing research, the term "international opportunity analysis (or assessment, or evaluation)" (IOA) was used almost as frequently as "IMS" to refer to a firm's search for attractive market targets around the world. This may have been due to various factors, including the relatively small number of reasonably accessible markets at the time (which made "IMS" less directly applicable in many cases), and the fact that international marketing was considered as a search for opportunities beyond one's home market at a time when internationalization was seen as the "Third Industrial Revolution" (Leighton, 1970) and was all the rage (which encouraged the use of "IOA"). Whatever the case, IOA in most cases was used as a synonym of IMS (e.g. see Yoshino, 1966; Liander *et al.*, 1967; Douglas *et al.*, 1982; Papadopoulos, 1983). While research under the IOA banner continues, today it is more likely to be used in reference to product- or country-specific in-depth analysis (e.g. Samiee *et al.*, 2004), international entrepreneurship (e.g. Zahra *et al.*, 2005), and other related themes.

Country risk analysis

"Country risk analysis (or assessment)" (CRA) refers to the many extant rating systems and methods for measuring foreign market risk, which are used by most of the world's largest global companies and organizations as aids in investment, financial, and political decisions. Some of these systems have been developed by academic researchers, some by private research agencies, and some by major international organizations (e.g. United Nations, World Bank). Examples include credit risk ratings by major banks and investment agencies (e.g. Moody's), the "Business Environment Risk Intelligence" system of BERI S.A., and the "International Country Risk Guide" (ICRG) of the Political Risk Service Group.

Downloaded from www.emerald.com/imr/article-pdf/28/2/132/1280656/02651331111122632.pdf by Vilnius University user on 30 October 2026

Understandably, CRA tends to attract more attention during periods of major international crises, such as the international debt debacle of the early 1980s, the period immediately following 9/11, and the 2008-2010 global financial crisis. Generally, CRA methods consist of both qualitative and quantitative instruments and are similar to, and suffer from the same methodological problems as, those of IMS. Needless to say, a key difference between IMS and CRA methods is the types of indicators used in each case. IMS studies are more likely to stress market potential, while those in CRA clearly emphasize "risk".

Environmental scanning

Environmental scanning is perhaps a more "neutral" assessment approach, combining elements of both IOA and CRA. The similarities between the two previous constructs, and the potential for fruitful borrowing from one to the other, are obvious – adding more "risk" variables to an IOA method, or more "opportunity" measures to a CRA approach, might well result in the two being quite similar. More than 40 years later, the suggestions made by Liander *et al.* (1967), which tended to incorporate both opportunity and risk factors, might appear to be better integrated than many newer models that have been put forth. Environmental scanning is a well-established field (e.g. Aguilar, 1967; Subramanian *et al.*, 1993) that deals with a number of business issues, but its relative "neutrality" is also, perhaps, its greatest weakness in the IMS context – i.e. the purposes for which environmental scanning may be undertaken are many and varied and therefore not necessarily suited to IMS, or, for that matter, international decision making of any kind. Nevertheless, there are clear overlaps between the two fields and, as was noted earlier, environmental scanning techniques have often been proposed as the first step in a complete IMS process (Cavusgil, 1985).

FDI location

IMS theory developed mostly in the context of internationalization and so most IMS studies deal with exporting and market-seeking firms, mostly of the SME type – while location theory for foreign direct investment (FDI) developed mostly in the context of MNEs, which may also be seeking resources, various operational efficiencies, and other strategic advantages (Dunning, 1998). The result of this relative divergence of foci has been as regrettable as it is not surprising: There is a near-total lack of interaction between the two areas. IMS research rarely, if ever, deals with FDI-oriented questions, and FDI location theory does not, by definition, deal with export-related issues. At the same time, closely related questions such as "market choice" in the case of mergers and acquisitions (i.e. whether in M&As the acquired company is chosen regardless of, or because of, its location) have been addressed only rarely and peripherally.

Nevertheless, target market potential, perhaps the most important IMS criterion, can also be an important (if not the most important) determinant of FDI location choice (e.g. Whitelock and Jobber, 2004), and is commonly seen as a contingency variable that substantively influences international strategic decisions (Ekeledo and Sivakumar, 1998; Whitelock, 2002). The fact that Dunning (1998) called location "the neglected factor" for MNEs, in an article that won the "2008 Decade Award" for the *Journal of International Business Studies* (and was reprinted by that journal in 2009), suggests that indeed a lot of work remains to be done in this area and that, by extension, greater interchange between FDI-focused location theory and export-focused IMS theory could benefit both. Furthermore, the need of FDI location research to study both

Downloaded from www.emerald.com/imr/article-pdf/28/2/132/1280656/02651331111122632.pdf by Vilnius University user on 30 October 2026

attractiveness and risk factors (e.g. Hatonen, 2009) suggests that studies in this area can offer useful integrative insights of the kind that current IOA, CRA, or environmental scanning approaches do not provide.

IMS and services

FDI-related issues acquire particular importance in the context of the services sector, which, most likely by default rather than by design, is studied only or mostly within the FDI literature when it comes to location choice. This is, again, because of the traditional IMS focus on exports, which are rarely an option for services. Instead, the producer-consumer inseparability in services means that in most cases international expansion necessitates direct investment in the target market. As a result, within FDI and/or services research the locational choice issue has been studied fairly extensively (e.g. Tahir and Larimo, 2004; Asmussen *et al.*, 2009), although, again, without the benefit of much insight from IMS research.

International market selection

As noted in the introduction, the "IMSel" component of IMS was where research in this area first developed, and so the former represents the bulk of published studies in the latter (in the broadest meaning of "IMS"). This research can be classified primarily into conceptual and empirical studies. Classical IMSel studies in the earlier literature tended to be mostly conceptual and addressed the normative question of how foreign markets must be selected (e.g. Deschampsneufs, 1967; Douglas and Craig, 1982; Papadopoulos, 1983; Cavusgil, 1985). Even though the various proposed models share some similarities, they also have many differences and there has been little consensus as to what an "ideal" IMSel process might look like. More recently, a limited number of empirical studies have looked at such issues as firms' market selection approaches (e.g. Brewer, 2001) and expansion pattern (Erramilli, 1991), and, importantly, the criteria used by firms in non-domestic market entry decisions (e.g. Whitelock and Jobber, 2004), the impact of IMS on performance (e.g. Brouthers and Nakos, 2005), and the development and testing of empirical models for IMS (Papadopoulos *et al.*, 2002; Brouthers *et al.*, 2009). As well, empirical findings from studies in cogent areas, such as those on the internationalization process of firms (Johanson and Vahlne, 1977) and psychic distance (e.g. Dow, 2000; Dow and Karunaratna, 2006) provide valuable insights on the IMS process and can be considered part of this research stream.

These and other studies were classified into various groups and analysed in the original inventory and taxonomy of research in this field by Papadopoulos and Denis (1988). In a more recent classification, Martín Martín and Papadopoulos (2005) used two criteria: the degree of systematization of the search for and analysis of information for IMS, to further distinguish between three approaches to IMSel: non-systematic, where no formal methods are used at any step of the process; semi-systematic, where only the search part is approached methodically; and systematic, where both the search and the analysis components are carried out using an ordered set of rules and procedures.

International market segmentation

While IMSel studies typically use the country as the unit of analysis, those in the IMSeg stream focus on cross-national segmentation and use the consumer or other buyer groups as the focal point. IMSeg makes great theoretical sense, since, after all, selecting

Downloaded from www.emerald.com/imr/article-pdf/28/2/132/1280656/02651331111122632.pdf by Vilnius University user on 30 October 2026

the right segmentation base is the first crucial step in any market segmentation exercise, and there is no particular reason why "country" should always be the right choice. In fact, the need to base targeting decisions on consumer- and product-based rather than national market characteristics had been recognized and stressed long before the newer interest in the cross-national approaches at the core of IMSeg (e.g. Cavusgil, 1985; Papadopoulos, 1987). In earlier times, both researchers and practitioners used the country as the unit of analysis, both because of lack of experience with "things international" and, mainly, because of the lack of cross-national data. Likewise, current interest in IMSeg is fuelled by contemporary conditions – larger and more experienced firms, more countries at advanced levels of development producing more information, and much greater sophistication in gathering, processing, and disseminating information.

Nevertheless, continuing and widespread difficulties in obtaining cross-national consumer data have constrained both IMSeg research in general and the number of countries included in the studies that are carried out. When firms consider the consumer as the unit of analysis (e.g. Bijmolt *et al.*, 2004; Boote, 1983; Lemmens *et al.*, 2007; ter Hofstede *et al.*, 1999, 2002), the national markets chosen for operations are the result of the selection of consumers across countries – but the relative dearth of consumer data trans-nationally very often means that the "country" must again become a central consideration, or at least a part of, the IMSeg decision-making process. Indeed, the empirical literature in this field has used general indicators at the country (e.g. Day *et al.*, 1988), regional (Askegaard and Madsen, 1998), and consumer (Yavas *et al.*, 1992) levels, or a mix reflecting some or all of these levels (e.g. Kotabe and Helsen, 2010). This literature has been reviewed and discussed by, among others, Steenkamp and ter Hofstede (2002) and Lemmens *et al.* (2007), with the latter researchers' conclusion essentially echoing a point we made just above – that most studies use the country as a basic unit of analysis probably due to the high costs and low availability of cross-national data.

Conclusions and directions for future research

As can be seen from the above overview, some areas are better developed than others, considerable overlap exists across various subfields, and each subfield seems to have developed almost in complete independence of the others, resulting in reduced (if any) cross-fertilization across all the areas, which, in one way or another, are interested in the study of markets. Considering both the complexities of the IMS process as well as its importance, one may reach two types of conclusions from the above review:

(1) First and most important, as researchers we seem to be badly in need of a unified theory of market choice. What such a "market" might be and how it might be defined is a second-order issue in terms of relative importance: depending on which or who is the firm, the decision maker, the product, and so on, there can be as many arguments for defining a market as "Denmark" or "Argentina" (IMSel) as there are for defining it as "18 year olds in such-and-such countries interested in cross-country skiing" (IMSeg). What is more important is the need to combine elements from the various subfields described above in order to strengthen, through the interchange of insights across them, the way that each approaches its primary objective. In summary, both scholars and decision makers in any stream and faced with any IMS-related decision would benefit from sharing

Downloaded from www.emerald.com/imr/article-pdf/28/2/132/1280656/02651331111122632.pdf by Vilnius University user on 30 October 2026

methodological approaches and insights, and this would ultimately contribute to a better-developed body of knowledge that would benefit all concerned.

(2) Further to the above general call for integration, the preceding overview clearly points to a large number of specific questions. Some of these were identified in our original call for papers for this special issue, some are addressed by the papers that were selected for it, and all represent areas of high research potential and impact. These include, but are certainly not limited to:

- Applying different methodologies from IOA, CRA, environmental scanning, FDI location, IMSel, and/or IMSeg methods to the same problem so as to systematically compare their results and examine the similarities and differences of the various approaches.
- Examining the theoretical underpinnings, determinants, and outcomes (e.g. performance) of IMS decisions.
- Developing frameworks that integrate specific theories relevant to IMS (e.g. OLI and Uppsala model).
- Differentiating, or examining the commonalities, between the "go/no-go", IMS, and MOE decisions.
- Comparing IMS in the export vs FDI context.
- Considering IMS approaches at different stages of internationalization.
- Examining geographic, cultural, and psychological distance factors influencing IMS decisions.
- Generally, engaging in more empirical research in IMS.
- Examining the effects of IMS decisions on global branding (global, national, and sub- or cross-national segments).
- Developing methods for assessing markets based on secondary data, primary research, or a combination.
- Addressing measurement issues in assessing market attractiveness vs, or concurrently with, risk.
- Investigating the relevance of IMS in the context of M&As.
- Studying IMS processes in small vs large firms, B2C vs B2B markets, products vs services, and specific sectors (e.g. services, retailing, advertising, banking).
- Carrying out longitudinal quantitative research to study temporal shifts in IMS constructs and indicators.
- Studying the dynamics of IMSel and IMSeg approaches and methods for predicting changes in patterns.

The special issue

Overview

The seeds for this special issue can be traced to a presentation at a special panel, organized by Dr Salah Hassan of George Washington University during the 2004 annual conference of the Academy of Marketing Science, in which the first author first put forth the IMSel–IMSeg distinction and called for research that would encourage integration and an interchange of methods and ideas between the two streams. The call for an integrated "IMS" approach, regardless of what the "S" might stand for, was well received, and so this *IMR* special issue was conceived from the outset as a way to

Downloaded from www.emerald.com/imr/article-pdf/28/2/132/1280656/02651331111122632.pdf by Vilnius University user on 30 October 2026

further advance that idea by helping to focus research attention on a theme, which, notwithstanding its great importance, and perhaps because of its complexity and broad scope, remains relatively under-researched. As we stated in the CFP, "the purpose of the special issue is to showcase cutting-edge, insightful research that will contribute substantively to the academic discourse and serve to stimulate further research in this field". We were gratified to see the substantive response of the research community, and as a result of it we feel that the special issue met its objectives and we hope it will become a reference point for researchers interested in IMS and its component themes.

A total of 31 manuscripts were submitted to the special issue and seven were selected for publication following a rigorous review process that engaged no fewer than 54 reviewers. Two of the papers involved one or the other of the Guest Editors as co-author, and to prevent conflict of interest these were submitted separately to the Editors of *IMR* and handled entirely at arm's length throughout the process via the central *IMR* office. Further, we invited a special paper by Susan Douglas and Samuel Craig, who have been seminal contributors to IMS research. Therefore, together with the present introductory article, the complete special issue comprises nine papers published in a "double special issue" as volume 28, issues 2 (with five papers) and 3 (with four papers).

The mention of the invited paper, just above, brings us to a note that, howsoever sad, must be made: the sudden passing of Dr Susan P. Douglas on 3 January 2011. During her long and productive career, Susan made a singular contribution to international marketing and international marketing research – indeed, in many ways she "was" international marketing. She was happiest when reading scholarly articles and writing, and her passion and excitement about research were hard to match. By the time this is published, the news of her passing will be widely known – but when we learned of it at that time, as we were putting the final touches on the special issue before sending it to print, it was a shock. Much as we would like things to be otherwise, we have the honour of handling one of her last articles. We join her co-author, Dr Craig, her colleagues at Stern and around the world, and her family and friends, in mourning her loss. Dr Douglas was a leader and a legend in our field, and her work will continue to influence all of us for many years to come.

Returning to the special issue and its content: considering the relative lack of empirical IMS research, it was good to see more empirical than conceptual papers in the final set accepted for publication. Taken as a whole, these papers provide an up-to-date view of the field. The conceptual papers contribute a number of important theoretical advances, as do the empirical papers through the use of a wide range of methodologies, primary and secondary sources of information as well as case research, and data analysis techniques such as structural equation modelling, regression, factor, and cluster analysis.

Contributions

The first part of the double special issue (28: 2) contains five papers. Following the present introductory article, which comprises an overview of IMS as a field of study, is the paper by Douglas and Craig, who focus their invited contribution on the need to consider how contextual factors may affect the effectiveness of managers' evaluation of foreign opportunities and design of international strategies. The authors note that, surprisingly, these factors have been largely ignored by previous research. To understand the contextual dimensions, they propose a framework that integrates

Downloaded from www.emerald.com/imr/article-pdf/28/2/132/1280656/02651331111122632.pdf by Vilnius University user on 30 October 2026

macro-level, meso-level, micro-level, and situational factors affecting consumption and purchase behaviour. Their contribution is mainly reflected in the remark that the sequential approach that is typically used by firms, namely, "focusing first on macro-level data and then selecting a limited number of countries to examine in more depth", can result in screening out markets that should have been left in, and vice versa, on the basis of information that these authors suggest ought to be considered not subsequently but concurrently.

The third paper, by Sheng and Mullen, focuses on macro-level factors and proposes a hybrid model for export opportunity analysis. The research gap addressed by these researchers is the lack of IMS models that are flexible, comprehensive, and cost-efficient enough to be used across various industries. Their model combines the marketing-based Overall Market Opportunity Index with the economics-based gravity model of international trade, such that variables from both models are used to analyse export market opportunities at the industry level.

Continuing with a macro-level perspective but focusing on an under-researched type of firms, international retailers, in the fourth paper Alexander, Rhodes, and Myers aim for a more robust understanding of the market selection process and its key drivers in this sector. The authors warn that IMS frameworks developed for other industries may not be applicable in retailing, and, like Sheng and Mullen, build a model based on gravitational theory and use an econometric approach to estimate it. The model advances our understanding of IMS decision drivers in the context of an increasingly important sector, and challenges assumptions concerning the role of managers in IMS decisions since their actions may be constrained by structural market conditions.

In the fifth and final paper of the first part of the special issue, Sousa and Lages develop a new measurement scale to assess psychic distance and investigate its impact on the adaptation of international marketing strategies. Psychic distance is an important explanatory factor in IMS, and conceptualizations and operationalizations of the construct have often ignored its perceptual and multidimensional nature. The study reveals that psychic distance is a higher-order construct comprising "country" and "people" distance and that both dimensions are positively and significantly associated with cultural distance and the adaptation of marketing mix strategies to foreign markets.

The second part of the double special issue (28: 3) contains four papers. The first is a significant conceptual contribution by Yaprak and Cannon, who provide a systematic framework for better understanding cross-national segmentation. The researchers classify the literature on cross-national segmentation into three interrelated streams of research, namely, methodological, content, and dynamic approaches, and propose the latter as a new perspective focusing on how cross-national segments develop and change over time and on their underlying rationale. The framework blends consumer value orientations with product/service characteristics and functionally vs symbolically motivated segments, and extends previous research by offering the possibility of understanding changes in cross-national segmentation. As such, it is expected to inspire research on value-based segmentation schemes across markets.

The second paper in Part II, by Cleveland, Papadopoulos, and Laroche, provides an application of cross-national segmentation that echoes some of the themes put forth by Yaprak and Cannon in the previous paper and, at the same time, is a relative rarity in IMS research in that it draws on primary consumer data. The study assesses the behaviours of a sample of over 2,000 consumers in eight countries, in relation to the respondents' ethnic identity vs cosmopolitan tendencies, for nine product categories used as the dependent variables. Its main conclusion, that ethnic and cosmopolitan

Downloaded from www.emerald.com/imr/article-pdf/28/2/132/1280656/02651331111122632.pdf by Vilnius University user on 30 October 2026

orientations need not be mutually exclusive and may vary by product category, has significant implications for standardization vs adaptation decisions in international strategy.

The next article, by Gaston-Breton and Martín Martín, builds on the previous papers as well as on the overall theme of the special issue by proposing an integrative approach to IMSel and IMSeg. After identifying a number of gaps in past research, including, importantly, the rare use of differences in consumer values in IMS research, the authors propose a parsimonious two-stage selection and segmentation model that integrates market attractiveness and consumer values (Inglehart's value system) as general segmentation bases. The model includes both country- and consumer-related analyses, and, in addition to its theoretical contribution in advancing an integrated view of IMS, is intended to help decision makers who deal with general public policies, and market-seeking MNEs, to identify and select suitable European target markets.

Lastly, the fourth paper, by Yeoh, reflects a unique contribution in that it is a case-based analysis of the internationalization strategies and patterns of two Indian pharmaceutical firms. IMS is connected to international expansion in general since the early days of the main internationalization theories. Whether extant theories such as the Uppsala model and OLI framework are sufficient to explain the internationalization of MNEs from emerging countries is an outstanding research topic. Considering differences in ownership advantages and strategy set pursued by the two emerging multinationals, the paper shows how their location choices were influenced by the firms' competitive advantages and by the disparity in their motives of resource-, market-, efficiency-, and strategic asset-seeking. This paper offers a comprehensive view of IMS in the broader context of internationalization, and fits particularly well with the integrative theme of the special issue.

In conclusion, we feel that the special issue papers make a valuable contribution, individually and collectively, to the IMS literature, and we agree with their authors that their findings are challenging and stimulating and can lead to a variety of new valuable directions for future research.

References

Aguilar, F.J. (1967), *Scanning the Business Environment*, Macmillan Co., New York, NY.

Askegaard, S. and Madsen, T.K. (1998), "The local and the global: exploring traits of homogeneity and heterogeneity in European food cultures", *International Business Review*, Vol. 7 No. 6, pp. 549-68.

Asmussen, C.G., Pedersen, T. and Dhanaraj, C. (2009), "Host-country environment and subsidiary competence. Extending the diamond network model", *Journal of International Business Studies*, Vol. 40 No. 1, pp. 42-57.

Bijmolt, T., Leo, H.A., Paas, J. and Vermunt, J.K. (2004), "Country and consumer segmentation: multi-level latent class analysis of financial product ownership", *International Journal of Research in Marketing*, Vol. 21 No. 4, pp. 323-40.

Boote, A.S. (1983), "Psychographic segmentation in Europe", *Journal of Advertising Research*, Vol. 22 No. 6, pp. 19-25.

Brewer, P. (2001), "International market selection: developing a model from Australian case studies", *International Business Review*, Vol. 10 No. 2, pp. 155-74.

Brouthers, L.E. and Nakos, G. (2005), "The role of systematic international market selection on small firms' export performance", *Journal of Small Business Management*, Vol. 43 No. 4, pp. 363-81.

Downloaded from www.emerald.com/imr/article-pdf/28/2/132/1280656/02651331111122632.pdf by Vilnius University user on 30 October 2026

Brouthers, L.E., Mukhopadhyay, S., Wilkinson, T.J. and Brouthers, K.D. (2009), "International market selection and subsidiary performance: a neural network approach", *Journal of World Business*, Vol. 44 No. 3, pp. 262-73.

Cavusgil, S.T. (1985), "Guidelines for export market research", *Business Horizons*, Vol. 28 No. 6, pp. 27-33.

Cavusgil, S.T., Kiyak, T. and Yeniyurt, S. (2004), "Complementary approaches to preliminary foreign market opportunity assessment: county clustering and country ranking", *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 33 No. 7, pp. 607-17.

Day, E., Fox, R.J. and Huszagh, S.M. (1988), "Segmenting the global market for industrial goods: issues and implications", *International Marketing Review*, Vol. 5 No. 3, pp. 14-27.

De Mooij, M. (2004), *Consumer Behavior and Culture: Consequences for Global Marketing and Advertising*, Sage, Thousand Oaks, CA.

Deschampsneufs, H. (1967), *Marketing Overseas*, Pergamon Press Ltd, Oxford.

Douglas, S.P. and Craig, C.S. (1982), "Information for international marketing decisions", in Walter, I. and Murray, T. (Eds), *Handbook of International Business*, John Wiley, New York, NY, pp. 3-33.

Douglas, S.P. and Craig, C.S. (1992), "Advances in international marketing", *International Journal of Research in Marketing*, Vol. 9 No. 4, pp. 291-318.

Douglas, S.P., Craig, C.S. and Keegan, W.J. (1982), "Approaches to assessing international marketing opportunities for small and medium-sized companies", *Columbia Journal of World Business*, Vol. 17 No. 3, pp.26-32.

Dow, D. (2000), "A note on psychic distance and export market selection", *Journal of International Marketing*, Vol. 8 No. 1, pp. 51-64.

Dow, D. and Karunaratna, A. (2006), "Developing a multidimensional instrument to measure psychic distance stimuli", *Journal of International Business Studies*, Vol. 37 No. 5, pp. 578-602.

Dunning, J.H. (1988), "The eclectic paradigm of international production: a restatement and some possible extensions", *Journal of International Business Studies*, Vol. 19 No. 1, pp. 1-31.

Dunning, J.H. (1998), "Location and the multinational enterprise: a neglected factor?" *Journal of International Business Studies*, Vol. 29 No. 1, pp. 45-66.

Ekeledo, I. and Sivakumar, K. (1998), "Foreign market entry mode choice of service firms: a contingency perspective", *Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science*, Vol. 26 No. 4, pp. 274-92.

Erramilli, M.K. (1991), "The experience factor in foreign market entry behavior of service firms", *Journal of International Business Studies*, Vol. 22 No. 3, pp. 479-501.

Hatonen, J. (2009), "Making the locational choice. A case approach to the development of a theory of offshore outsourcing and internationalization", *Journal of International Management*, Vol. 15 No. 1, pp. 61-76.

Johanson, J. and Mattsson, L. (1988), "Internationalisation in industrial systems – a network approach", in Hood, N. and Vahlne, J. (Eds), *Strategies in Global Competition*, Croom Helm, London, pp. 287-314.

Johanson, J. and Vahlne, J.-E. (1977), "The internationalisation process of the firm: a model of knowledge development and increasing foreign market commitments", *Journal of International Business Studies*, Vol. 8 No. 1, pp. 23-32.

Koch, A.J. (2001), "Selecting overseas markets and entry modes: two decision processes or one?" *Marketing Intelligence and Planning*, Vol. 19 No. 1, pp. 65-75.

Kotabe, M. and Helsen, K. (2010), *Global Marketing Management*, 5th ed., Wiley, New York, NY.

Downloaded from www.emerald.com/imr/article-pdf/28/2/132/1280656/02651331111122632.pdf by Vilnius University user on 30 October 2026

Leighton, D.S.R. (1970), "The internationalization of American business: the third industrial revolution", *Journal of Marketing*, Vol. 34 No. 3, pp. 3-4.

Lemmens, A., Croux, C. and Dekimpe, M.G. (2007), "Consumer confidence in Europe: united in diversity?" *International Journal of Research in Marketing*, Vol. 24 No. 2, pp. 113-27.

Leonidou, L.C., Katsikeas, C.S. and Samiee, S. (2002), "Marketing strategy determinants of export performance: a meta-analysis", *Journal of Business Research*, Vol. 55 No. 1, pp. 51-67.

Liander, B., Terpstra, V., Yoshino, M.Y. and Sherbini, A.A. (1967), *Comparative Analysis for International Marketing*, Marketing Science Institute, Allyn and Bacon, Boston, MA.

Malhotra, S. and Papadopoulos, N. (2007), "International market selection: an integrative review of empirical studies", in *Proceedings, Administrative Sciences Association of Canada, International Business Division, Ottawa, ON, June 2-5*.

Malhotra, S., Sivakumar, K. and Zhu, P.C. (2009), "Distance factors and target market selection: the moderating effect of market potential", *International Marketing Review*, Vol. 26 No. 6, pp. 651-73.

Martín Martín, O. and Papadopoulos, N. (2005), "International market selection (IMS): an analysis of the selection criteria used by firms", *Proceedings of the 34th EMAC Conference, Milan*.

Martín Martín, O. and Papadopoulos, N. (2007), "Internationalization and performance: evidence from Spanish firms", *Journal of Euromarketing*, Vol. 16 Nos 1/2, pp. 87-103.

Oviatt, B. and McDougall, P. (1994), "Toward a theory of international new ventures", *Journal of International Business Studies*, Vol. 25 No. 1, pp. 45-64.

Papadopoulos, N. (1983), "Assessing new product opportunities in international markets", in *New Product Development*, European Society for Opinion and Marketing Research, Amsterdam, pp. 69-89.

Papadopoulos, N. (1987), "Approaches to international market selection for small and medium sized enterprises", in Rosson, P.J. and Reid, S. (Eds), *Managing Export Entry and Expansion: Concepts and Practice*, Praeger, New York, NY, pp. 128-53.

Papadopoulos, N. and Denis, J.E. (1988), "Inventory, taxonomy and assessment of methods for international market selection", *International Marketing Review*, Vol. 5 No. 3, pp. 38-51.

Papadopoulos, N. and Martín Martín, O. (2010), "Toward a model of the relationship between internationalization and export performance", *International Business Review*, Vol. 19 No. 4, pp. 388-406.

Papadopoulos, N., Chen, H. and Thomas, D.R. (2002), "Toward a tradeoff model for international market selection", *International Business Review*, Vol. 11 No. 2, pp. 165-92.

Papadopoulos, N., Malhotra, S. and Martín Martín, O. (2011), "International market selection and assessment", in Wilkinson, T.J. (Ed.), *International Business in the 21st Century*, Ch. 10, Vol. I, Praeger, Westport, CT (forthcoming).

Robertson, C. and Chetty, S.K. (2000), "A contingency-based approach to understanding export performance", *International Business Review*, Vol. 9 No. 2, pp. 211-35.

Root, F.R. (1994), *Entry Strategies for International Markets*, D.C. Heath, Lexington, MA.

Sakarya, S., Eckman, M. and Hyllegard, K.H. (2007), "Market selection for international expansion: assessing opportunities in emerging markets", *International Marketing Review*, Vol. 24 No. 2, pp. 208-38.

Samiee, S., Yip, L.S.C. and Luk, S.T.K. (2004), "International marketing in Southeast Asia: retailing trends and opportunities in China", *International Marketing Review*, Vol. 21 No. 3, pp. 247-54.

Downloaded from www.emerald.com/imr/article-pdf/28/2/132/1280656/02651331111122632.pdf by Vilnius University user on 30 October 2026

Sarasvathy, S.D. (2001), "Causation and effectuation: toward a theoretical shift from economic inevitability to entrepreneurial contingency", *Academy of Management Review*, Vol. 26 No. 2, pp. 243-63.

Simon, H.A. (1959), "Theories of decision-making in economics and behavioral science", *The American Economic Review*, Vol. 49 No. 3, pp. 253-83.

Steenkamp, J.-B.E.M. and ter Hofstede, F. (2002), "International market segmentation: issues and perspectives", *International Journal of Research in Marketing*, Vol. 19 No. 3, pp. 185-213.

Subramanian, R., Fernandes, N. and Harper, E. (1993), "Environmental scanning in US companies: their nature and their relationship to performance", *Management International Review*, Vol. 33 No. 3, pp. 271-86.

Tahir, R. and Larimo, J. (2004), "Understanding the location strategies of the European firms in Asian countries", *Journal of the American Academy of Business*, Vol. 5 Nos 1/2, pp. 102-9.

Ter Hofstede, F., Steenkamp, J-B.E.M. and Wedel, M. (1999), "International market segmentation based on consumer–product relations", *Journal of Marketing Research*, Vol. 36 No. 1, pp. 1-17.

Ter Hofstede, F., Steenkamp, J-B.E.M. and Wedel, M. (2002), "Identifying spatial segments in international markets", *Marketing Science*, Vol. 21 No. 2, pp. 160-77.

Westhead, P., Wright, M., Ucbasaran, D. and Martin, F. (2001), "International market selection strategies of manufacturing and services firms", *Entrepreneurship and Regional Development*, Vol. 13 No. 1, pp. 17-46.

Whitelock, J. (2002), "Viewpoint: theories of internationalisation and their impact on market entry", *International Marketing Review*, Vol. 19 Nos 4/5, pp. 342-48.

Whitelock, J. and Jobber, D. (2004), "An evaluation of external factors in the decision of UK industrial firms to enter a new non-domestic market: an exploratory study", *European Journal of Marketing*, Vol. 38 Nos 11/12, pp. 1437-55.

Yavas, U., Verhage, B.J. and Green, R.T. (1992), "Global consumer segmentation versus local market orientation: empirical findings", *Management International Review*, Vol. 32 No. 3, pp. 265-73.

Yoshino, M.Y. (1966), "International opportunities for American retailers", *Journal of Retailing*, Vol. 42 No. 3, pp. 1-10.

Zahra, S.A., Korri, J.S. and Yu, J. (2005), "Cognition and international entrepreneurship: implications for research on international opportunity recognition and exploitation", *International Business Review*, Vol. 14 No. 2, pp. 129-46.

About the authors

Nicolas Papadopoulos is Chancellor's Professor of Marketing and International Business at the Sprott School of Business of Carleton University in Ottawa, Canada. His research focuses on international strategy and buyer responses to it and includes expansion strategy, place images and branding, and international market systems. He has over 250 publications, including books, book chapters, conference papers, and recent articles in such journals as *International Business Review*, *Journal of International Business Studies*, *Journal of International Marketing*, *Journal of Macromarketing*, and *International Marketing Review*. He is a member of six journal editorial boards including *International Marketing Review* and the *Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science*.

Oscar Martín Martín is an Assistant Professor at the Public University of Navarre (Spain) and an Associated Researcher at Uppsala University (Sweden). His research focuses on three main areas in international business. The internationalization process of firms – comprising expansion by born globals, psychic, cultural, and country distance, international market

Downloaded from www.emerald.com/imr/article-pdf/28/2/132/1280656/02651331111122632.pdf by Vilnius University user on 30 October 2026

selection and segmentation, and performance; country of origin awareness and effects; and MNEs, including the development and transfer of innovations and the role of headquarters. He has published in refereed journals such as *International Business Review, International Marketing Review* and *Management International Review*, book chapters and conference proceedings. Oscar Martín Martín is the corresponding author and can be contacted at: oscar.martin@unavarra.es

Acknowledgements

The Guest Editors are grateful to all the authors for their hard work on their research and manuscripts, and to all the reviewers for their valuable contribution in helping us to develop a strong special issue. They thank the *IMR* Editors, Jeryl Whitelock and John Cadogan, and the team at Emerald, especially Martyn Lawrence, the Publisher, for their support. The Guest Editors are particularly thankful to Dr Whitelock, who helped us materially throughout the development process.

The following reviewers refereed papers for the special issue; to protect their anonymity, the list does not include the six reviewers who refereed the papers involving us as co-authors – they were selected separately by the *IMR* Editors and are not known to us. The names and affiliations (as of the review time) of the remaining 48 reviewers are as follows:

- Sanjeev Agarwal, Iowa State University, IA, USA.
- Henrik Agndal, Stockholm School of Economics, Stockholm, Sweden.
- Gerald Albaum, University of New Mexico, Alberquerque, NM, USA.
- Nicholas Alexander, Lancaster University, Lancaster, UK.
- Otto Andersen, University of Agder, Agder, Norway.
- George Balabanis, City University, London, UK.
- Gabriel R. G. Benito, BI Norwegian School of Management, Bergen, Norway.
- Paul Brewer, University of Queensland, Queensland, Australia.
- Lance Eliot Brouthers, Kennesaw State University, Kennesaw, GA, USA.
- Julio Cerviño Fernández, Carlos III University of Madrid, Madrid, Spain.
- Mark Cleveland, University of Western Ontario, London, ON, Canada.
- Nicole Coviello, Wilfrid Laurier University, Waterloo, ON, Canada.
- Tevfik Dalgic, University of Texas at Dallas, Dallas, TX, USA.
- Dimitris K. Despotis, University of Piraeus, Piraeus, Greece.
- Douglas Dow, University of Melbourne, Melbourne, Australia.
- Statia Elliot, University of Guelph, Guelph, Canada.
- Charlotte Gaston-Breton, Carlos III University of Madrid, Madrid, Spain.
- David Griffith, Michigan State University, MI, USA.
- Jan Johanson, Uppsala University, Uppsala, Sweden.
- Martin Johanson, Uppsala University, Uppsala, Sweden.
- Stavros Kalafatis, Kingston University, Kingston, UK.

Downloaded from www.emerald.com/imr/article-pdf/28/2/132/1280656/02651331111122632.pdf by Vilnius University user on 30 October 2026

- Anna Kaleka, Cardiff University, Cardiff, UK.
- Robert Krider, Simon Fraser University, Vancouver, Canada.
- Robert J. Kwortnik, Cornell University, Ithaca, NY, USA.
- Luis Filipe Lages, Universidade Nova de Lisboa, Lisbon, Portugal.
- Jorma Larimo, University of Vaasa, Vaasa, Finland.
- Chol Lee, Sogang University, Sogang, Republic of Korea.
- Julie Anne Lee, University of Western Australia, Crawley, WA, Australia.
- Shavin Malhotra, Ryerson University, Toronto, Canada.
- Robert E. Morgan, Cardiff University, Cardiff, UK.
- Susan M. Mudambi, Temple University, Philadelphia, PA, USA.
- Michael R. Mullen, Florida Atlantic University, Boca Raton, FL, USA.
- Lilach Nachum, City University of New York, NY, USA.
- Sam Okoroafo, University of Toledo, Toledo, OH, USA.
- Mark Palmer, Aston Business School, Aston, UK.
- Piet Pauwels, Maastricht University, Maastricht, The Netherlands.
- José I. Rojas-Méndez, Carleton University, Ottawa, Canada.
- Katharina P. Roth, University of Vienna, Vienna, Austria.
- Sema Sakarya, Bogaziçi University, Bogaziçi, Turkey.
- James Sallis, Uppsala Universitet, Uppsala, Sweden.
- Saeed Samiee, University of Tulsa, Tulsa, OK, USA.
- Stephanie Slater, Cardiff University, Cardiff, UK.
- Anne Souchon, Loughborough University, Loughborough, UK.
- Barbara Stöttinger, Vienna University of Economics & Business, Vienna, Austria.
- Hester van Herk, VU University, Amsterdam, The Netherlands.
- Peter Walters, The Hong Kong Polytechnic University, Hong Kong SAR, China.
- Van R. Wood, Virginia Commonwealth University, Richmond, VA, USA.
- Sengun Yeniyurt, Rutgers University, New Brunswick, NJ, USA.

To purchase reprints of this article please e-mail: **reprints@emeraldinsight.com**
Or visit our web site for further details: **www.emeraldinsight.com/reprints**

Downloaded from www.emerald.com/imr/article-pdf/28/2/132/1280656/02651331111122632.pdf by Vilnius University user on 30 October 2026